Virtual Bone Health Program
2026

Home Fall Hazard Checklist

https://vbh-app.pages.dev/

Western HealthSciences

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HAND & UPPER LIMB CENTRE RESEARCH
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Home Fall Hazard Checklist

Use this list and check off all the ways to find and fix hazards in your home and help prevent falls. Ask a family member or friend to help you work through this list.

DRIVEWAY AND FRONT DOOR

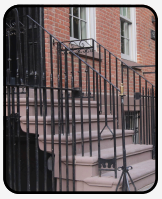
- [ ] If you park your car in the driveway, do you feel comfortable and at ease entering and exiting your car (i.e. no issues with the slope or surface of the driveway, lack of space, etc.)?
- [ ] Can you enter and exit your car comfortably without leaning on the car door?

✗



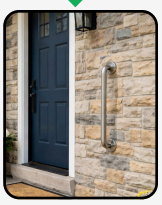
- [ ] Is your driveway and the path to the entrance of your home safe, even, intact, and level (i.e., no cracks in surfaces, no uneven stones, and no inclines)?
- [ ] Is your path and driveway clear and clean (i.e., free of ice, snow, clutter, grease, garden tools, hoses, other)?
- [ ] Do you have outdoor lights that illuminate the path from your driveway to your door at night?
- [ ] Is the light switch to the lights easily accessible for you to turn on and off?
- [ ] If you have steps leading to your front door, are they safe, even, intact (i.e., no wobbly or cracked steps) and consistent in height?

✓



- [ ] If you have steps, is there a secure railing on both sides of the steps that extends beyond the bottom and top of the steps?

✓



- [ ] Is there an outdoor grab bar near your door?

DRIVEWAY AND FRONT DOOR

- [ ] Can you easily enter your home? Are you free from any entrance problems (e.g., unlocking the door; in an apartment, maneuvering from entering passcode to the door; getting buzzed in and rushing to the door)?



- [ ] Can you easily and comfortably step through the entrance/threshold to your home?

KITCHEN

- [ ] In your kitchen, do you keep the items you use most on shelves between your shoulder and hip level?



- [ ] When you need to reach up high, do you use a stable step stool with a bar to hold on to (i.e., not a chair or another piece of furniture)?

- [ ] Is there enough counter space in your kitchen?

- [ ] Is there enough space for you to move around in your kitchen (i.e., can you open the oven and the fridge easily and move around spaciously)?

- [ ] If you have a pet, does it stay out of the way when you are busy (e.g. during meal preparation, house work, etc.)?

- [ ] Is the floor clean and free of spills, food, grease, and other clutter?

- [ ] Can you easily move food from the kitchen to the eating area (e.g., dining room)?

HALLWAYS

When you walk from your common sitting area (e.g., couch) to your bathroom, your path should be safe and spacious. Is your pathway...

Check all that apply:

- [ ] Clear of furniture?
- [ ] Free of clutter?
- [ ] Free of wires?
- [ ] Free of unsecured carpets and other floor coverings?



- [ ] Well-lit?

When you walk from your common sitting area (e.g., couch) to the phone, your path should be safe and spacious. Is each criterion below fulfilled?

Check all that apply:



- [ ] Free of clutter
- [ ] Free of wires
- [ ] Free of unsecure carpets and floor coverings
- [ ] Well-lit

- [ ] Do you have a bathroom on each floor of your house?
- [ ] Do you have a telephone on each floor of your house?
- [ ] Are all common walkways spacious and devoid of furniture?

HALLWAYS

- [ ] Are all of your wires and cords placed near walls and not in walkways in each room?

- [ ] Are there any dangerous thresholds/steps?



- [ ] Is there enough space in your hallways (e.g., do doors open into your rooms instead of out of the hallways)?

BEDROOM

- [ ] In your bedroom, is your bed at a height that makes it easy to get into and out of (i.e., not too high, nor too low)?



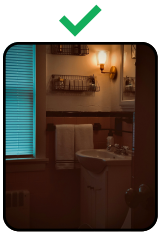
- [ ] If you get into bed from the bedside next to the wall, is there enough room between your bed and the wall to easily move around and use any devices you may need (e.g., walker)?

- [ ] Is your bedside light easy to reach?

- [ ] Can you easily and conveniently reach and access any items you need in your bedroom (e.g., T.V. remote, eyeglasses)?

- [ ] Is there a telephone near your bed?

BEDROOM



- [ ] Do you have a nightlight in your bedroom or your bathroom to help you find your way at night?

When you walk from your bedroom to your bathroom, your path should be safe and spacious. Is each criterion below fulfilled?

Check all that apply:

- [ ] Clear of furniture?
- [ ] Free of clutter?
- [ ] Free of wires?
- [ ] Free of unsecured carpets and other floor coverings?
- [ ] Well-lit?

BATHROOM



- [ ] Does your shower floor or bathtub floor have a non-slip mat or non-skid strips?

- [ ] Do you have a bath chair in the shower area?

You should have support grab bars (i.e. not towel racks) to help you get in and out of your shower or bathtub. Do you have bars...



Check all that apply:

- [ ] On the wall?
- [ ] Fastened to the bathtub?

BATHROOM

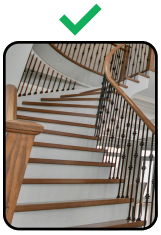
- [ ] Is the bath at a reasonable height for you to easily get in and out? Does the shower have a safe step/threshold that you can easily step over?



- [ ] Is there a non-slip rug on the bathroom floor next to the shower or bathtub?
- [ ] Is the toilet seat at a height that allows you to easily get on and off?
- [ ] Are there support grab bars next to the toilet?
- [ ] Are all items such as the towel racks, sink top, toilet seat secure and easy to reach?

STAIRS

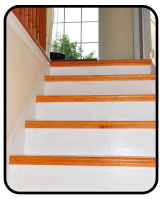
- [ ] Are your stairs made of a non-slip material?
- [ ] Are there raised edges on the stair treads?
- [ ] Are your stairs clear of clutter?



- [ ] Are handrails on both sides of the stairs and as long as the stairs?
- [ ] Are the handrails secure and intact?
- [ ] Is there a light switch at the top and bottom of the stairs?

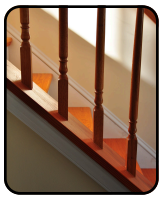
STAIRS

Your stairs should have contrasting colors like you see in this picture:



Check all that apply:

- [ ] Do the top surfaces of stairs contrast in color with the side edges?
- [ ] Does the floor at the bottom of the stairs contrast in color with the stairs?

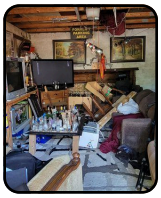


- [ ] Are the steps a reasonable steepness? Is the tread about 279 mm (11") and is the riser about 178 mm (7")?

LAUNDRY ROOM

- [ ] Is there enough space for you to move around in your laundry room?
- [ ] Is your washer and dryer at heights you can easily reach?
- [ ] Do you have sufficient space to easily open and close the washer and dryer doors?
- [ ] Is your laundry room clutter-free?

GARAGE

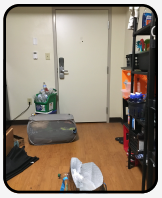


- [ ] Is your garage clutter-free?
- [ ] Is your garage grease stain-free?

GARAGE

- [ ] Is your garage brightly lit throughout?
- [ ] Is there a clear path for you to walk from your car to your door?
- [ ] In your garage, are all shelves and storage units secure?
- [ ] When your car is in the garage, do you find it easy and do you have enough space to get in and out of the car safely?

GENERAL



- [ ] Inside your home, is the floor even, non-slippery and clutter-free (i.e., no papers, towels, shoes, boxes on the floor)?
- [ ] Are all carpets and other floor coverings secured without rolled-up edges?
- [ ] Are different floor surfaces consistent (e.g., is there an even transition from wooden floor to tiles)?
- [ ] Are all thresholds/doorways safe and clearly visible?
- [ ] Does every room have bright lights that you can easily turn on and off?



- [ ] Is each light switch located by the entrance of each room so you don't have to walk through the dark?

GENERAL

- [ ] Is the furniture in every room secure and stable (i.e., not wobbly, properly assembled, and secured to the floor)?
- [ ] Can you walk through the furniture in each room easily and spaciously?
- [ ] Can you easily walk around your house without leaning on the furniture for support?
- [ ] Is each seat (e.g., chairs, couches) in your home at a height that allows you to get up and sit down easily?

APPAREL

- [ ] Do you wear properly hemmed, well-fitted clothing that doesn't drag or bunch up?

Your outdoor shoes should be safe. Are your outdoor shoes...

Check all that apply:

- [ ] Slip-resistant?
- [ ] Closed-toe?
- [ ] Flat-heeled?



- [ ] Do you have a mat right beside your door to wipe your feet?



- [ ] In icy and snowy conditions, do you wear ice traction devices on your shoes or boots (such as Yak Trak Walkers)?